Love Goes On and On

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General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F, Multi

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)/Kesi (Defiance)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Kesi (Defiance), Lyari (Defiance), Lyra (Defiance), Original Male Character(s)

Additional Tags:
Tooth-Rotting Fluff, Cuddling & Snuggling, Valentine's Day Special, Polyamory, Canon Lesbian Relationship, Canon Lesbian Character, Secret Relationship, Catra in a Suit (She-Ra), Piercings, Tattoos, Picnics, Kesi Cult, Kesi is the Besti, Recursive Fanfiction, POV Catra (She-Ra), POV Kesi (Defiance)

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by tp9829, Zelenal

Summary

Catra and Kesi are both hopelessly in love with Adora and they show it in their own ways.

Notes

Happy Valentine's Day to all those reading this when it first goes live! Or if you happen to be reading it when it on a future Valentine's Day.

- Inspired by Defiance by TheNotebookWizard

Chapter 1: Tattoos and Tailors

Chapter Summary

After spending way too long in a boring meeting, Catra takes Adora out on their weekly shopping trip/date with a very special plan in mind.

Royal Audience Chamber

Halfmoon Castle

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Almost Ten Years After the Coup Attempt

Catra could admit it, she was bored. The current petitioner was prattling, as long winded as Cloudfoot ever was and twice as boring. Her mother listened with the normal royal guise of attention but the slight twitch of her tail behind her and the careful sips of tea showed her own growing boredom. Everyone in the room appeared to be growing tired as the morning stretched on into what should have been lunch and the figure continued to prattle on and on about some quotas for fishing and that the Crown would have to support his venture or they would lose out to the fishfolk markets.

Catra had tuned out about twenty minutes in, which was about an hour ago now. Only one person in the room seemed to be able to maintain her focus, Catra was sure it wasn't on the petitioner but instead on looking like she should. Her bodyguard, her best friend, her *khai'tel.* Adora stood in rapt attention in an approximation of the palace uniform that she put together, her wooden *kiari* secured safely in a belt loop. The girl was as steady as a rock—no lounging or relaxing like everyone else in the

audience chamber—her back ramrod straight, face impassive. Catra came up with a little plan. If her future knight wanted to look so serious, she would dissuade her of that notion.

Adora stood over her shoulder with less than a dagger's length between them—the only other people she would trust behind her were Kesi and her family—close enough that with a quick *flick* her tail brushed the taller girl's knee. Her armour (that she was allowed to wear—she was an Acolyte of the Temple, not a soldier) cut off around the waist and she was wearing leggings beneath that. She felt the soft brush against her girlfriend's knee. The feeling shot electricity up her tail and made her shudder, and she heard her girlfriend's breath hitch slightly. She smirked; this would make the rest of the meeting interesting.

She leaned forward in her chair, her tail trailing up the front of Adora's leg. "Of course, Master Wilco, the Crown must consider its options." She wrapped her tail tightly around Adora's leg, who had made a half step forward to follow her leaning. "The Crown has many businesses that requires subsidies including some of your competitors. What do you provide for Halfmoon that they do not?" Her mother turned to look at her eyebrow raised, then she followed the path of her tail towards Adora's leg and frowned. She merely smiled up at her mother innocently.

Master Wilco owned one of the large fishing trawlers that prowled the Dark Lake to catch a large portion of their supplies; Catra was willing to bet that the man was so confident in his position that he would overplay his hand, all while she played a game with Adora.

The man spluttered and began to rant about his overinflated importance. Lyra next to her saw exactly what she was doing both to get this over with quickly and to tease Adora. While she kept trailing her tail up and down Adora's exposed calf, her mother began to press the merchant on how their subsidy would be spent. If Catra was honest, this was the kind of thing she was born to do: pushing arrogant peoples buttons for the good of everyone else in the kingdom.

The meeting took maybe another ten minutes, and during that time, her tail never left Adora's leg. Eventually, the Royal Family agreed to subsidise the fishing company for a portion of control of the company. Most of the logistics of it went above Catra's head. She turned to find Adora red-faced, sweat beading on her brow, and staring at some point on the far wall. She let out a breath as the tail left her skin.

She stood and grabbed at Adora's hand possessively. Thankfully, that this was over now they can get to their actual date they had planned.

Lyari's Boutique

Crescent Market

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Almost Ten Years After the Coup Attempt

Catra really didn't know how Adora came to this decision, but it was something she wanted to do and dreaded doing. Apparently, Adora had discovered some book on Etherian customs and found out about tattooing: the act of imbuing one's skin with art. She had taken that book to Lyari who had looked into how to work it on Etherians. Now, weeks later, she had come back to Adora and said that she was ready.

What made this confusing for Catra was Adora's absolute terror at the sight of a needle—something from her time in the Horde that had never left her despite Lenio's best efforts—and when Adora got scared, Catra wanted to hold her close and not let go. She had talked about her fear late into the night last night, how it wasn't real, how if she did this it would prove she was stronger than that terror that gripped her heart.

"Are you sure this is the design you want?" Lyari's voice was kind. Adora had begged and pleaded with her to get this done, but now her pale skin was almost ghost white with terror as she gripped Catra's hand.

Lyari held up a drawing; it looked like a broader version of Adora's *kiari* with a blade of strange blue glass with a circular sapphire set into a winged golden pommel. Catra herself didn't recognise it, but it held some importance to Adora and Kesi. Adora nodded and took her place at the table.

"Alright," Lyari took her place on Adora's left side, forearm exposed. "This might take a little while, so be patient." There was a faint buzz of the machine that Lyari used starting up, and Adora stared at it for a moment, her other hand flexing and then clenching. Before she could clench it all the way, Catra snaked her hand in so they were intertwined.

"It's okay, Adora. Be brave for me okay?" she purred down at her. Holding her hand tight, Adora's grip was like iron. Any more pressure and it would hurt, but even in this moment of fear, she was gentle enough not to hurt her.

Adora stared back at her, grip tight. "Your eyes are so pretty," she said apropos of nothing. Was she getting delirious? "I keep dreaming of your eyes and…" she glanced down where Lyari had started her work, small droplets of blood shone on her pale skin.

"What is it? If you don't mind me asking?" Adora had kept it close to her chest, another secret of the faith. One that Adora and Kesi shared but she as someone who only sorta believed wasn't privy to.

"It's from the old stories about She-Ra. Like the ones Cyrus used to read to us." She stared at some point past Catra as she spoke. "They said the last She-Ra was a first one who wielded a sword like this. Every night for the past few years—ever since I started training with Askar—I dream of being out in the woods. Not any woods I recognise but the trees seem familiar, and there's

this sword. I know I should be scared of it, somehow I know it's frightening, but it seems to know me. I can only calm myself down by thinking of you."

Catra leaned forward against her chest and started to purr. "Thank you. For thinking of me, for sharing." Adora began to relax under the purr, which drowned at the buzz of the machine. Lyari was politely ignoring the conversation happening next to her and when Catra met her eyes, she just smiled at her.

Adora seemed to calm down, her vice-like grip on Catra's hand relaxing and instead petting through her mane. Catra's own hand roamed up Adora's free arm, gently feeling away at the slowly loosening muscles underneath her claws. The girl before her had started to put on muscle at a maddening rate; soon, she would be bigger than Askar. As the minutes bled to hours in the comfortable silence with Adora petting her and Catra purring and stroking Adora's arm, the two just lay there enjoying each other's company.

After a few hours, Lyari pulled back. Examining her work. It was gorgeous. A single length that seemed to shimmer on Adora's skin like fractal glass. Adora stared at it a moment.

"Now, you'll want to keep it bandaged and apply moisturising cream to it every few hours. Keep pressure off of it if you can." She was clearly reading off a list from memory. "Treat it like you would any other open wound—I know you are serious about those." Adora went to say something but Lyari interrupted with: "And no magical healing. I don't know if it would heal the skin and get rid of the tattoo. Don't want all this to go to waste." Adora's mouth snapped shut.

"Thank you, Lyari," Catra said smoothly, helping Adora to her feet. "I'll make sure you get paid for it properly." With that, she grabbed Adora by her good arm, and dragged her out of the store. Adora switched from staring at the new art marking her skin to stare at Catra, a smile breaking out on her face.

The Market Square

Crescent Market

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Almost Ten Years After the Coup Attempt

Catra felt the need to move. Sitting still waiting for a few hours, especially after being stuck in a meeting all morning, **was not** Catra's idea of a good date. She loved Adora, and she liked Lyari well enough, but sitting in a small shop waiting was not a fun experience. For Adora, she would tolerate it, but now she needed to move.

They had gone from calmly walking to running down the streets. Everyone moved out of their way—if anyone saw either of them, they would know that the other was close by. The Princess was always followed by her future knight, and the only Etherian (the common folk of Halfmoon weren't privy to her secret) in Halfmoon was always trailed closely by the one of the only Magicats to scamper on the surface in a generation. Adora and Catra: inseparable.

She had ran ahead, and Adora ran behind her, unable to truly keep pace since Catra would get down on all fours, and none of the adults dared to *tut* at her. Being the Princess had it's perks. She had made it to Tathlan's first, and picked out some snacks for the two of them, which was almost done by the time Adora caught up. Despite sprinting halfway across the Market, Adora was barely winded.

"Catra, please stop running ahead!" she shouted as she approached. "How am I supposed to protect you if you run off?" She reached her at the end of the question.

Catra turned, holding the steaming buns full of cinnamon out to her as a way of apology. "I'm sorry, Adora. Would a snack help you to forgive me?" She had perfected a sarcastic tone from Percival.

Adora snatched the bun and took a bite, moaning as she did so. Her own bite of the bun was divine. Fresh baked sweet bread mixed with cinnamon: one of Adora's favourite snacks. The two ate in silence, Adora leaning against Catra's shoulder. After they had finished, Catra made sure to give Adora extra bottles of the flavoured waters that she had come to love while Catra drank tisane.

After they finished, Catra dragged Adora shopping. These weekly trips to the Crescent Market had quickly become her favourite time, just her and Adora hanging out trying on new clothes and browsing the Market.

They would spend time at Lyari's and between all the little boutiques. Sometimes Caspin would join them alongside Kittrina who, despite keeping up the affect of a stern guard, seemed to know the Market inside and out, chatting with each shopkeeper as if she attended regularly. But today she intended to drag Adora someplace; it would just be the two of them.

So, a clothing boutique full of fancy suits. She had not taken to wearing dresses at any point in her life as the Princess, especially after she started training as a sorceress and in fighting. There was an old merchant who made suits in what was considered fashionable in Salineas prior to the burning of the forests of Halfmoon. Catra had discovered this little shop and had instantly fallen in love with the collection. Today, she had a piece to pick up as a commission to commemorate ten years since the failed coup. No one knew about it except Kittrina—she had organized it while Adora was training.

Adora raised an eyebrow at the tiny little shop, but as she entered, she gasped at the rows of fine suits. The store's owner, Lieur—a tabby looking Magicat with mismatched fur and a pair of

wire rim glasses resting on the bridge of his nose—smiled as she entered.

"Ah, Your Highness, your order is ready for collection. Would you like to try it on first?" He stood and made his way over to a shelf, collecting a large, carefully wrapped package. She took it from him. He gestured at a large changing room, situated at the back of the shop.

Adora took a seat nearby, staring at the varied items. None of it was particularly her style. Despite not being a Magicat, the girl was born for the caves, and these suits covered far more than any cave girl would ever desire. It was Catra's one misgiving about the commissioned work, that Adora might want to see more skin.

She stepped inside and unwrapped the package. It was perfect. Layers of fine burgundy cloth woven into a form fitting jacket over a maroon shirt, long pant leggings of the same material all of which would allow her to easily move. She quickly shed her current clothes and changed into the suit, leaving the bow tie undone and the top buttons loose.

She looked herself over in the mirror. She thought she looked good, attractive, she might even stretch as far as hot. But there was only one way to know for sure. "Hey, Adora," she heard a brief rustling of movement, "could you come in here?"

The curtain pulled back for a moment and Adora stepped inside, her mouth open to say something but she paused just staring at Catra's form, mouth hanging open.

"I'm struggling with the tie, can you help?" she feigned innocence well enough, but Adora's reaction proved that this plan would work, as long as she wasn't a coward about it.

"Uh… Yeah, of course." Adora stepped close, so close Catra could feel her breath on her cheek as Adora grasped both ends of the undone tie around her neck.

Adora fumbled for a moment with the tie in hands. Normally, she was good with anything involving dexterity, but Catra so close to her seemed to be throwing her off. She smirked up at her, tail lashing in excitement. “Hey, Adora,” she purred out, “forget the tie.” Adora looked at her confused, not letting go of the tie for the moment. “Kiss me.”

Her expression was stunned, and Catra almost feared she had pushed it to far, when Adora stuttered out a “What?” a blush crawling up her cheeks. Catra knew it was perfect.

“You want to be my loyal knight?” she smirked at Adora’s blush growing even deeper with those words. “Then kiss me. Consider it an order from your Princess.”

Adora’s lips crashed into hers. It wasn't the chaste few kisses they had shared in the past a handful of times, this was hungry and desperate. She grabbed onto Adora’s well muscled shoulders just to have something to anchor herself while Adora pulled on the lapels of her jacket, lifting her right onto the tips of her toes. Her fur felt warm and her tail was lashing in excitement. This was everything she had dreamed kissing Adora would be. She could stay like this forever with Adora’s hungry mouth pressed against hers, exploring in ways that definitely wasn’t mentioned in all the books she had read on the subject.

They were interrupted by a soft *“ahem”* from beyond the curtain. Adora leapt back as if dodging a sword blow. Her eyes were blown wide and she was panting like she only did after the most intense training sessions.

“If Her Highness is pleased with the purchase?” she heard from beyond the curtain. “Then she may finish her purchase at the counter.” The clear sound of footsteps retreated away.

She waited a few seconds as Adora stared at the curtain in a certain amount of horror. “Shall we go back to my room? So I can get this packed away, and we can continue. In privacy.” Adora stared at her, breathing finally settling.

They just barely made it back to her rooms before resuming.

Chapter 2: Totally Not a Date

Chapter Summary

> Despite being imprinted, Kesi and Adora can't properly date thanks to magic number theory. It's a shame(?) that "going on a date" and "hanging out with a friend" are basically the same thing.

The Training Grounds

Halfmoon Castle

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Ten Years and Nine Months After the Coup Attempt

Kesi watched with rapt attention as Adora worked on her form, her *kiari* a veritable blur as she spun it this way and that. Kesi normally didn't care to watch Adora train but everything had changed ever since Kesi imprinted on her a couple weeks ago. Now, she was keenly interested in watching as Adora's muscles flexed with each swing of her blade, each shift of her stance.

It was like watching poetry in motion, the way Adora's body moved. It was like an intricate and deadly dance, one that Adora had memorized all of the steps to forward, backward, and sideways. Kesi couldn't help but be entranced as she watched, even as Adora's blade moved so quickly that she couldn't properly track it.

Eventually, Adora's training came to an end and Adora finished with a flashy sequence that even Kesi could tell was more for style than practicality. She then went through her cool down exercises before flourishing her *kiari* and sheathing it in her belt.

Kesi clapped excitedly as Adora let out a steadying breath before making her way over to her. Kesi knew that the extra sequence at the end was largely Adora showing off to her, wanting to impress her with her impeccable handling of her *kiari.* It warmed Kesi's heart that her *khai'tel* wanted to look cool to her, even though she didn't have to try to do that. Adora was *easily* the coolest person that Kesi knew (an opinion that she had held even *before* the imprint).

"That was great, Adora!" Kesi cheered, causing Adora to smile. Once she got close, Kesi stood up from the bench she had been sitting on and handed her a towel and water bottle.

"Thanks, Kesi," Adora replied as she first wiped down her face and arms before taking controlled sips of her water. It was curious how Adora needed more water to stay hydrated than anyone else but that was just one of the many things that made Adora who she was.

"So, are you ready to go out or do you want to stop by my rooms to wash up first?" Kesi asked as she collected her wicker basket and began to follow Adora out of the training grounds. Adora had several changes of clothes in both Kesi's and Catra's rooms for whenever they had a sleepover.

Adora hummed in thought for a moment as she clipped the water bottle to her belt opposite her *kiari.* "I didn't work up that much of a sweat—this was pretty light exercise—so I should be good to go. Unless you think I need to?"

Kesi chuckled lightly. "Your scent's a bit stronger than normal but not *that* much stronger. Of course, I'm a *really* bad judge of that now since 'you but stronger' always smells good to me."

"What *do* I smell like to you?" Adora asked with a tilt of her head.

"Like warm honey," Kesi answered easily. "What about me? What do I smell like to you?"

Adora hummed in thought again. "Like sandalwood and leather; it's *really* nice."

Kesi knew that Adora would like her scent—that's just how these things worked with imprints—but it still made her smile and purr slightly as her tail swayed happily.

"Say, what's in that basket you're carrying?" Adora asked as she eyed the item in question.

Kesi gave Adora a smile that highlighted her cat features. "That's a secret for later~" she answered in a sing-song voice. "Now, come on, let's get going!"

Lyari's Boutique

The Crescent Market

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Ten Years and Nine Months After the Coup Attempt

"Kesi! Adora! Welcome!" Lyari greeted as she hurried out from behind the counter to hug them. "What can I get for you two today?"

"I'm here to get my nose pierced," Adora answered as she followed Lyari deeper into the store.

Lyari perked up at the news. "Ooooo. Getting a bit more adventurous, are we? What part are you looking to get pierced?"

"The septum," Adora answered as she started to browse through Lyari's stock of nose piercings.

Lyari nodded. "Interesting first choice; people usually pierce a nostril first. Fair warning: those can hurt a *lot.* Well, they can for a

Magicat but it probably won't be too much more pleasant for you, either."

Adora scowled slightly as she eyed a simple silver loop. "I have a high pain tolerance; I'll be fine," she answered plainly before pointing at the piercing she had been looking at. "I'll get this one."

"Alright, then!" Lyari said with a clap of her hands before grabbing the piercing in question. "Just give me a few minutes to get everything set up and we'll get you taken care of!"

As Lyari went deeper still into the boutique, Adora and Kesi continued to browse, pointing out bits of jewelry that they liked but didn't want to get and picking up a thing or three. They eventually got to the tail accessories and Adora found herself frowning once again.

"Man, you guys are so lucky to have tails. Look at all this great jewelry I can't wear!" Adora complained as she held up an intricately carved, rose gold tail cuff.

"I'm sure that you could order these but sized as a bracelet or anklet, Adora," Kesi said placatingly.

"That's not really the point," Adora said with a shake of her head. "That's just *one* thing that's so cool about having a tail. I can't even do sign language properly without one or ears like yours and I've seen you do things like open and close doors when your hands are full. And then there are the times when you or Catra will wrap it around my arm and just—" Adora let out a sigh of frustration.

Kesi's heart went out to her *khai'tel.* She knew that, somewhere deep down, Adora hated the fact that she wasn't also a Magicat, that she felt like an other, an outsider. What was worse was that there wasn't much she could really *do* about that other than…

"Adora…" Kesi began softly. She glanced at where Lyari was and figured that she had enough time. So, she bent down slightly

to run a scent mark along Adora's jaw. "We love you just the way you are. Not just Catra and me but also King Cyrus and Queen Lyra and Kelara and all of our friends."

Adora sighed again even as she leaned into the affection. "Yeah, I know," she said somewhat dejectedly.

"Hey, there are things you can get that's pointless for us like tattoos," Kesi pointed out. "Your tattoo of the Sword of Protection looks *great* and a Magicat getting one would be rather silly. Maybe you could get another one?"

"Maybe," Adora allowed, "but even so—"

Any further attempts at reassuring Adora were cut off as Lyari called out, "I'm ready whenever you guys are!"

Kesi gave Adora one last reassuring smile which Adora returned weakly before they headed back to the piercing studio. Kesi wasn't sure what it would take to get Adora to not feel bad about what she wasn't but she'd just keep loving her until she did.

The Crescent Market

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Ten Years and Nine Months After the Coup Attempt

"Are you sure you like the piercing, Adora? You can take it out if you don't," Kesi said after Adora sniffed and slightly scrunched her nose for the tenth time in so many minutes. They had just left Tethlan's bakery and Kesi now had a box of pastries balanced atop her basket.

"Yeah, I'm fine. It just feels weird right now, is all," Adora reassured her. "So, are you finally going to tell me what's in that basket?"

Kesi blushed slightly, her tail somewhat lashing as she looked away from Adora. "Well, seeing as how it's almost lunch time, I thought that maybe we could go on a picnic, if you wanted."

Adora beamed up at Kesi, the expression making her relax once she glanced back and saw it. "That sounds great! Did you have a spot in mind?" she asked as she casually grabbed Kesi's hand, interlacing their fingers. While they had held hands countless times in the past—what with both of them being physically affectionate people and all—it felt *different* now, sending a pleasant tingle up Kesi's arm and leaving her chest warm.

"Of course!" Kesi replied with a bright smile of her own. "There's this park near the High Temple that has a *great* view of Halfmoon that I always thought would be a *lovely* place for a picnic."

Adora nodded. "Yeah, I think I know which one you're talking about. Catra and I have taken Caspin there a few times. I also like to go there at night after particularly stressful days and just watch the lights of the city."

"That sounds lovely. We should do that the next time we have a sleepover in your room."

"Yeah, we totally should."

And so the two continued onward, occasionally talking about inconsequential things but often just walking in comfortable silence, occasionally greeting people that they knew as they passed. The trek from the Crescent Market to the High Temple was a decently long one but it was also a familiar one, one that they've walked countless times before and would likely walk countless times more until Adora was knighted after turning eighteen and began living in the palace as Catra's Appointed Knight.

Kesi very much looked forward to that day for a myriad of reasons. Aside from it being the culmination of the years of hard work that Adora's undergone, it meant that they'd be together pretty much all hours of the day. As Catra's Seneschal, Kesi was usually with Catra unless she had the day off (such as today) and Adora would basically become Catra's shadow.

Thinking about it, Kesi wondered something and decided to ask for Adora's opinion.

"Hey, Adora?" Kesi asked as they neared their destination. At Adora's answering hum, she continued. "Once you become Catra's Appointed Knight, do you want your own apartment in the palace or do you want to just split your things between mine and Catra's?"

Adora hummed in thought for a moment. "Well, I should *probably* have my own apartment for the sake of propriety but it'll probably almost never be used. I've already gotten pretty used to sharing a bed with either you or Catra. It's honestly a little hard to sleep on my own these days."

Kesi giggled as they finally reached the park. "I feel the same way. Oh, just so you know, you're spending the night with me on the night before your eighteenth birthday."

Adora chuckled. "Do I get a say in that?"

"Nope!" Kesi replied cheerfully. "Catra's already agreed to give me that day off. There's *so much* that I want to show you and do with you."

Adora glanced around the area to see that it was sparsely populated (another reason Kesi had chosen this park) before pressing up against Kesi's side and whispering, "Including kissing me?"

Kesi felt herself blush as her traitorous tail decided to curl around Adora's arm. "*Especially* that. That's going to be the first thing I do once we're both awake that day."

Adora blushed slightly and leaned her head against Kesi's shoulder as she said in a soft voice, "I look forward to it."

Now at one of the little oases of surface nature that was the park, Kesi led Adora to the spot she had chosen before setting her basket and the box of pastries down. From her basket, she pulled out a simple blanket and laid it out with Adora's help before sitting down.

As Adora sat down next to her, Kesi pulled out a few containers containing sandwiches and fried catfish that she had made herself and two thermoses of tisane. Adora cuddled up next to Kesi after she had finished laying everything out and the two ate largely in silence as they relaxed in the nature around them and each other's company while admiring the view of Halfmoon from so high up.

Eventually, once they were finished eating, Kesi laid down and held her arms open. Adora immediately jumped on the offer and laid down as well, her head pillowed on Kesi's shoulder and one arm draped across her stomach while their legs tangled together. Kesi's tail came up to wrap around Adora's calf as she wrapped her arms around her, pulling her that much closer.

Adora sighed in bliss as she began to idly pet Kesi's side. "I love you, Kesi," Adora said softly as she snuggled impossibly closer.

Kesi's heart felt so full that she thought it might burst as a deep purr sprung to life, triggering Adora's pseudo-purr in return. "I love you, too," Kesi returned as she buried her nose in Adora's blonde hair.

Kesi luxuriated in the feeling of Adora on top of her. Whenever they cuddled up to go to bed during sleepovers, Kesi tended to end up on top of Adora despite being the taller of the two for a number of reasons (ever since the imprint, one of those reasons being so that way Kesi could press her nose against Adora's pulse point and enjoy her scent more). As such, it was a rare treat for

Kesi to feel Adora's weight on top of her, pressing her down like the world's most comforting blanket.

Just like with holding hands, they had cuddled and said that they loved each other countless times in the past. Being free and open with your affection was the norm with cave culture and, as very affectionate people, the two of them embraced that aspect wholeheartedly. After the imprint, however, everything just *felt* so much different, so much *more.* At least to Kesi, they felt less like simple actions or statements and more like promises, promises to always be there, to always keep loving each other.

Kesi fully intended to keep every last one of those promises.

As the two drifted off for a quick nap, Kesi's last thoughts were of how she wanted to do nothing more than to kiss the girl in her arms and how the remaining two years until she could do so couldn't pass quickly enough.

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